

November 19, 1386, the parliament was no sooner dissolved, than de Vere, and the rest of the king's friends, representing to him his dependent state, urged him to take active measures to release himself from the thralldom in which the obnoxious ordinance had placed him. The king's chief advisers, besides de Vere and Tresilian, were Alexander Neville, Archbishop of York; Michael de la Pole, the late chancellor; and Sir Nicholas Brambre, an alderman of London. After endeavouring in vain to tamper with the sheriffs of the several counties to ensure the election of subservient members for the next parliament, they summoned all the judges to a council at Nottingham, on August 25, 1387, and by violent threats compelled them to attach their signatures to a series of questions and answers, which had been already prepared by Chief Justice Tresilian, the purport of which was to declare the "new statute, ordinance, and commission to be derogatory to the royalty and prerogative of the king;" that all the persons concerned in procuring and making it were traitors, and ought to be punished with death; and that the judgment against Michael de la Pole was erroneous and revocable.

So awkwardly, however, had they concerted their plans, that the whole plot came speedily to the knowledge of the lords commissioners, who forthwith appealed the archbishop, de Vere, de la Pole, Tresilian, and Brambre of high treason. This occurred on November 17, 1387; when the king promised to summon a parliament in the following February that justice might be done. During the interval the archbishop, de Vere, and de la Pole found safety in flight; not, however, without some futile attempts on the part of de Vere to resist the commissioners by force of arms. Tresilian also in the first instance fled, and might have escaped but for his own infatuation. His place as chief justice was filled up on January 31, 1388, by the appointment of Walter de